

AFRICAN AI NETWORK (AAN)

COMPREHENSIVE LEARNER CODE OF CONDUCT & HONOR CODE

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Scope: All Learners, Fellows, and Alumni

PREAMBLE & MISSION ALIGNMENT

The African AI Network (AAN) is committed to developing the next generation of ethical technology leaders. This Code of Conduct ("the Code") is not merely a set of rules but a commitment to the values of integrity, excellence, and mutual respect. By joining this program, every learner agrees to uphold these standards in all interactions—virtual, physical, and professional.

THE HONOR CODE

"As a member of the AAN community, I pledge to:

1. Complete all academic work with honesty and original thought.
2. Respect the intellectual property of others and the institution.
3. Actively contribute to a safe, inclusive, and professional learning environment.
4. Hold my peers accountable to these same high standards."

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY & AI POLICY

3.1. Definition Of Plagiarism

Plagiarism is the representation of another's words, ideas, or data as one's own. This includes:

- **Direct Copying:** Using snippets or full blocks of text without quotation marks and citation.
- **Mosaic Plagiarism:** Patching together phrases from various sources.
- **Self-Plagiarism:** Resubmitting work previously submitted for another module or program.

3.2. Ethical AI Usage

While AAN encourages the use of AI tools, learners must:

- Disclose the use of generative AI in their submissions where required.
- Ensure the final output reflects their own critical analysis and understanding.
- Never use AI to bypass the learning objectives of a core assessment.

BEHAVIORAL EXPECTATIONS & PROFESSIONALISM

4.1. Communication Norms

Learners must adhere to "Netiquette" in all Slack, Discord, or Portal channels:

- No "trolling," flaming, or use of profanity.
- Respect for diverse viewpoints across cultures and borders.
- Professional tone in all correspondence with Mentors, Staff, and Peers.

4.2. Harassment And Bullying

AAN maintains a zero-tolerance policy for harassment, including but not limited to sexual harassment, cyberbullying, and discrimination based on race, gender, religion, or disability.

VIOLATION CLASSIFICATIONS (LEVELS 0-3)

Category	Description	Examples
Level 0 (Low)	Minor lapses in professionalism or administrative compliance.	Late check-ins, minor "Netiquette" slips, missing non-core deadlines.
Level 1 (Moderate)	Intentional but isolated breaches of policy.	First-time minor plagiarism, unprofessional emails to staff.
Level 2 (High)	Serious breaches affecting the integrity of the program.	Major plagiarism, sharing assessment answers, repeat Level 1 offenses.
Level 3 (Critical)	Egregious misconduct or illegal acts.	Falsification of documents, harassment, theft, physical/verbal abuse.

DISCIPLINARY MATRIX & SANCTIONS

Misconduct Type	Classification	Typical Corrective Action
Academic Dishonesty (Major)	Level 2/3	Zero grade for unit, removal of honors, or suspension.
Unprofessionalism (Repeat)	Level 1/2	Written Warning, mandatory coaching, or Learner Success Plan.
Bullying/Harassment	Level 3	Immediate Suspension pending investigation; likely Expulsion.
Unauthorized Distribution of Content	Level 2/3	Legal notice and immediate expulsion from the network.

PROCEDURAL FLOW FOR MISCONDUCT

7.1. Incident Reporting

Any member of the community can report a violation via the **Official Grievance Form**. Reports are reviewed by the Learner Experience (LX) Team within **48 hours**.

7.2. Investigation And Summons

- **Notice of Inquiry:** The learner is notified of the allegation and given **10 business days** to prepare a response.
- **The Conduct Committee:** A panel of 3 impartial staff members reviews evidence.
- **The Finding Letter:** A formal decision is sent within **5 business days** post-hearing.

7.3. The Appeals Process

Appeals must be submitted within **5 business days** of the decision. Valid grounds for appeal include:

- **New Evidence:** Substantial facts not available during the initial hearing.

- **Procedural Error:** Evidence that the process outlined in this document was not followed.
- **Bias:** Proven prejudice by a committee member.

8. FINAL AUTHORITY

The Head of Learner Experience and the Provost hold final authority over all Level 3 decisions. All data regarding disciplinary actions are stored in accordance with AAN's Privacy Policy and may be shared with partner organizations if the misconduct violates professional placement terms.

Acknowledgment: *By accessing the AAN Learning Portal, I acknowledge that I have read, understood, and agree to be bound by the terms of this Learner Code of Conduct.*